



THE

SCEPTIC'S DESK

AI TRADING, DEMYSTIFIED

THE SCEPTIC'S TOOLKIT

EDITION 2026 · V1.0

FREE SAMPLER

• 6 PROMPTS · 1 PAGE OF RISK

The Sceptic's Starter Pack

"Five prompts, one page of risk, no hype."

A free sample of The Sceptic's Toolkit. Five of the forty-two prompts from the Prompt Vault, one for each stage of the loop, plus a bonus prompt that I run every morning, plus the survival mathematics cut down to a single page you can keep beside your screen.

▶ 5 PROMPTS + 1
BONUS

▶ ONE-PAGE RISK
SHEET

▶ FILL IN THE
HIGHLIGHTED BLANKS

▶ TOOL-AGNOSTIC

The Sceptic's Starter Pack

THE SCEPTIC'S TOOLKIT

VERSION 1.0

EDUCATIONAL CONTENT, NOT FINANCIAL ADVICE





● START HERE

How to use the Starter Pack

● ~5 MINUTES

● EDITION 2026 · VERSION 1.0

THE ONE IDEA

B

Better questions create better traders.

1 Paste your context first

One paragraph at the top of any chat: your account size, the markets you trade, your risk per trade, your experience, and the time you actually have. Every prompt below gets sharper the moment the AI knows who it is talking to.

2 Pick the prompt for the job

Five prompts covering the main stages of the loop: learn, build, test and improve, plus a bonus morning routine. Grab the one that fits the moment rather than working through them in order. Copy them all at scepticsdesk.com/starter-pack/prompts

3 Fill in the highlighted blanks

Swap each *[highlighted blank]* for your own detail, then send. That is the whole method.

4 Verify before you act

Every answer is a draft, not a fact. Check numbers, quotes, and code against a real source, and never let an AI decide what to buy.

SHARPEN ANY PROMPT

Staple-on lines that work on almost anything here: “tell me where you’re uncertain”, “cite your sources”, “give me the strongest counter-argument”, and “what am I not asking that I should be?”

THE ONE RULE

An AI is your analyst, not your decision-maker. Verify everything and keep a human hand on anything that moves money.

FIVE-MINUTE CHALLENGE

Let it attack one of your own strategies

- 1 Copy prompt 14, Devil’s advocate, from the next page.
- 2 Paste in one of your own strategies, rules and all.
- 3 Ask it to attack the idea, then sit with what comes back.

If it finds one thing you had never considered, that was a single prompt. There are forty-one more.





● FIVE OF FORTY-TWO · PART ONE

Learn, build, test

Numbered as they appear in the full Prompt Vault, so anything you like here is easy to find later.

Learning & understanding

PHASE · LEARN

05 WHY WOULD A PRO DISAGREE?

PROMPT [LEARN](#)

I believe [a trading belief I hold]. Give me the strongest case an experienced trader would make against it, and what evidence would tell me I'm wrong.

Strategy building

PHASE · BUILD

14 DEVIL'S ADVOCATE

PROMPT [BUILD](#)

Argue as hard as you can against this strategy. In what conditions does it lose? Worst realistic losing streak? Hidden costs? Is it fitted to a story, or is there a real reason it works? Be blunt. [strategy]

↓ WHAT COMES BACK

"Your edge is a volatility edge, and you have not said so. In quiet ranges the breakout fails and you pay the spread again and again. On this rule set a run of seven to nine losers is entirely normal, so ask yourself whether you would still be following it at loss six. Nothing here accounts for slippage on the open, which is where a good deal of the backtested profit tends to live. And three parameters tuned on the same two years is a story, not evidence."

ILLUSTRATIVE AI RESPONSE, ABRIDGED. YOUR OWN ANSWER WILL BE SPECIFIC TO YOUR RULES.

Backtesting

PHASE · TEST

26 OVERFITTING AUDIT

PROMPT [TEST](#)

Assume I've fooled myself. Find signs of overfitting or unrealistic assumptions in this backtest, and tell me how to test it out-of-sample. Be sceptical. [paste results + rules]





Improve

Risk & sizing

PHASE · IMPROVE

31 POSITION SIZE

PROMPT **IMPROVE**

My account is [amount] and I risk 1% per trade. I want to [buy/sell] [instrument] at [entry] with a stop at [stop]. Work out cash at risk, stop distance, and exact size. Show the steps and state your assumptions.

Review & psychology

PHASE · IMPROVE

37 JOURNAL REVIEW

PROMPT **IMPROVE**

Act as a blunt, experienced trading coach. From this journal, find where I make versus lose money, whether I follow my own rules, any emotional patterns, and my single highest-impact fix for next month. Use my real numbers. Don't flatter me. [paste journal]

BONUS 12 · MACRO CALENDAR READ

The one I run every morning before I look at a single chart. It takes about two minutes and it stops me trading blind into a scheduled event.

[paste context block] Give me this week's scheduled data and events for my markets that could cause volatility, ranked by likely impact. Cite sources. End with 'what could make this read wrong'.

↓ USE IT WITH A WEB-CONNECTED MODEL, THEN CHECK THE CALENDAR YOURSELF

THAT IS THE LOOP

Six prompts covering learn, build, test, improve, and the morning routine that starts the day. The full Vault runs to forty-two across seven categories, and the rest of the desk is on the last page.



Risk, on one page

Prediction is optional; risk management is what keeps you in the game. Four numbers, one comparison, and three questions.

THE ONE IDEA

Protecting capital is the strategy.

THE 1% RULE

$$\text{Cash at risk} = \text{Account} \times 1\%$$

Risk no more than 1% of your account on any single trade, 2% at the very most. Not timidity: it is how you survive the inevitable losing streak.

EXPECTANCY

$$\begin{aligned} & (\text{Win\%} \times \text{Avg win}) \\ & - (\text{Loss\%} \times \text{Avg loss}) \\ & - \text{Costs} \end{aligned}$$

Your long-run result per trade. Positive over a large sample is the whole game. You can win under half your trades and still profit if the winners dwarf the losers.

POSITION SIZING

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Size} &= \text{Cash at risk} \\ &\div (\text{Stop distance} \\ &\times \text{value per point}) \end{aligned}$$

Once the stop is set, size is just arithmetic. Confirm the loss at the stop equals your risk before you click.

REWARD-TO-RISK

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Reward-to-risk} &= \\ & \text{Target distance} \\ & \div \text{Stop distance} \end{aligned}$$

- ▶ Minimum **1.5:1** ; aim for **2:1** or better.
- ▶ **R** means one unit of risk. Score results in R, not just in pounds.

WHY SMALL RISK SURVIVES

RISK 1% • TEN
LOSSES

-10%

A +11% gain puts you back. Still in the game.

vs

ONE 50%
DRAWDOWN

+100%

The gain needed just to break even.

THREE QUESTIONS BEFORE ANY AI-DRIVEN ACTION

- 1 Do I understand why?
- 2 Can I verify it independently?
- 3 What happens if it's wrong?

If you can't answer all three, you don't act yet.

What a stop-loss is, and isn't. A stop is an instruction, not a guarantee of the exact fill. Gaps, slippage, and leverage can blow past it in fast markets. Size assuming the occasional loss may be worse than planned, and never let one trade seriously hurt your account.



● READY FOR THE COMPLETE SYSTEM?

Starter Pack, or the whole desk

You have a slice of the workflow. The Toolkit is the rest of it, and it is a one-off purchase rather than another subscription.

	STARTER PACK	FULL TOOLKIT
Copy-paste AI prompts	✓ 5, plus a bonus	✓ 42 across 7 categories
Risk reference	✓ One page	✓ Full Risk Cheat Sheet
Flagship guide	× Not included	✓ 20 pages, 7 workflows
Worked case studies	× Not included	✓ Four traders, start to finish
Position Size Calculator	× Not included	✓ Interactive
Trade Checklist	× Not included	✓ Included
Trading Journal	× Not included	✓ Excel and Notion
PRICE	Free	£89 • Lifetime

WHY £89

Most traders spend more than that every year on indicators, signal groups, and courses they never really use, and have nothing left the following January. The Toolkit is not a signal service. It is a workflow you keep: the prompts, the risk mathematics, the sizing, and the record that tells you the truth afterwards. One payment, no subscription, and every update to the 2026 edition included.

GET THE TOOLKIT

Stop guessing. Start running a repeatable workflow.

Built from hundreds of hours putting AI models against real trading workflows, and used daily to research markets, build strategies, and review trades.

Get the Toolkit →

£89 • LIFETIME ACCESS • INSTANT DOWNLOAD

Educational content, not financial advice. Nothing here is a recommendation to buy or sell any instrument, and no result is promised or implied. Most retail traders lose money. Practise on a demo account and only risk what you can afford to lose. Free prompt library:

scepticsdesk.com/starter-pack/prompts

